

Founders School Student Life Handbook

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Everything here is a proposal, built from research and due diligence. Much of it should be developed with the Founding Families and the students before it takes effect. Students write and vote on the house norms, and families and staff shape the rest with them.

Terms used throughout

- **Safety floor:** the short list of rules that no vote can change because breaking one risks safety. It covers signing out, substances and weapons, guests, medications, reporting concerns, and violence or harassment. Section 4 lists each rule with its reason. Founding Families and staff agree on it before moving in.
- **Town Hall:** the weekly student-run meeting where students write and vote on every house norm above the Safety floor.
- **RA:** the Head of Student Life, who lives in the house. A trained backup RA covers nights off.

At a glance

Two buckets. Safety: every student safe in body and mind, at home and around New York. Culture: a house and life students are proud of, with a full schedule of things to expand them.

Something to keep in mind: CLAP (Alex Banayan). Connection, Learning, Altruism and Play. A good week in the house has some of each, plus healthy, protein-centered food and movement most days.

The Six Commitments

1. Students write the house norms at a weekly Town Hall. Adults hold only the Safety floor.
2. Every consequence fixes the problem and ends when it is fixed. Walks and exercise are never taken away.
3. The RA meets every student one-on-one each week, always where others can see.
4. Families hear from the house several times a week.
5. Every evening offers something better than a laptop, including three movement nights a week.

6. Freedom grows with measurable house standards.

Milestones. By 3 months, every student's interests are mapped and the first Town Hall election is held. The house has found its rhythm. By 6 months, the weekly rhythm runs and norms hold without policing. There are deep relationships forming. Students are referencing experiences from enrichment experiences in other parts of their life. By 12 months, a new RA can run a full week from this handbook (section 12) and the students run the house.

1. Purpose

The boarding program for Founders School is designed to provide the safety needed to feel at home, and the experiences needed to sophisticate the students.

This means that the evenings and weekends will be full of opportunities that allow for students to enjoy and learn about the world they are improving.

This handbook is the operating plan for that portion of the Founders School boarding students' weeks. The Head of Student Life is responsible for it.

The work sorts into two buckets.

Safety. Every student must be physically and psychologically safe in the house and around the city, in this case New York. **A home is a feeling as much as it is a place.**

Culture. How a person celebrates, how they interact with others, insights they develop, come from exploring the world they live in. The habits that become them are built along the way.

2. Principles

Everything in this handbook, and in life in general, comes back to principles we choose live by these are my proposals for the principles of Founders School Home Life:

High standards and high support. These practices will not change as the students transition from school into their time outside of school. The standards will be high, and the support with it. [Source](#)

Transparency.

- Parents should know what is going on at all times in the house. Students should have the same transparency.
- The meaning of rules, conversations, outings, and other practices will be clearly stated.

Leave things better than you found them.

- This inspires presence, and responsibility.

Depth

- We will be full people, not one-dimensional or closed-minded. We allow for quirks and weirdness because, let's face it, we're all a little weird; we just would rather celebrate it unconditionally.
- We sit with discomfort and vulnerability calmly (Bodhicitta).

We do it for the group

- House decisions are made together.
- The house's interests come before any one person's.
- Hold high standards, be respectful, and offer support to the same standard.

We celebrate the good times

- Wins are real events.
- We treat friends' wins as our wins.
- Make celebrations memorable, and keep them appropriate.

We stick together

- The people we live with are not there to walk in front of us and lead us, or behind us and follow us. They are beside us because they are our friends.
- We observe the buddy rule the way Navy SEALs do.

We are all different, we recognize that, and we win

- Differences are what make groups special and successful. We appreciate the differences and learn ways to work with them best.

We round up (Alex Hormozi)

- We assume those in our home have the best of intentions.
- We act as though that is true and approach any frustrations with curiosity.

We are first-class people, living first-class lives

- We believe early is on time.

- We do not publicly criticize others.
- Your word is binding.
- We tell the truth even when it's uncomfortable.

What this looks like in the house

Principle	In practice	What we avoid
High standards, high support	A clear bar for rooms, chores, and curfew, with an adult who helps a kid reach it	Punishments with no path back
Transparency	Every Safety floor rule comes with its why	Rules posted with no explanation
We do it for the group	Students write the house norms at Town Hall	Adults write every rule
Responsibility achieves independence	Freedom grows as students show they can handle it	Same restrictions for everyone forever
We stick together	Weekly house dinner, roommate repair before room switches	Kids eating alone in their rooms

3. First 30 days

The house culture forms in the first month. This plan makes sure it forms into an intentional positive one.

Before move-in

- ☐ Call every family. Ask what their kid is like when stressed, what helps, and any health or medication needs.
- ☐ Send families a one-page note: the weekly rhythm, how and when they'll hear from you, and a heads-up that homesick calls in the beginning weeks are normal. La Lumiere advises parents not to promise early trips home and to encourage weekends in the house so friendships form. [Source](#)
- ☐ Set roommate pairs: shared interests, different backgrounds.
- ☐ Send families the draft Safety floor and ask for their input before it is final.
- ☐ Collect photo consent from every family and student, for the selfies and activity pictures sent home (section 8).

Week 1: arrive and belong

Day	Focus
Move-in day	Unpack together, house tour, first family dinner, walk the block as a group
Day 2	Safety floor walkthrough with the reason for each rule, then the first Town Hall: students draft starter norms and pick interim roles
Day 3	Neighborhood orientation: subway stop, pharmacy, urgent care, meeting point if separated
Day 4	One-on-one with each student, 15 minutes: "What would make this place feel like yours?"
Day 5	First big group outing, run on the norms from Day 2
Days 6 to 7	First cooking night; first weekend trip

Week 2: norms voted. Town Hall turns the starter norms into the first full set and votes on them (section 4). Adults bring only the Safety floor. Families get the norms that passed.

Week 3: norms go live. Chores rotate. The first student leadership roles open for application (section 11).

Week 4: review. Second round of one-on-ones. Town Hall revisits what's working. Send families a first-month note with one specific, true thing about their kid.

Watch for in month one: a student who skips group meals, stays in their room on the weekend, or calls home more each week instead of less. Any of these means a check-in that day (section 7).

4. House Town Hall

Students write, vote on, and enforce the house norms at a weekly meeting they run. Adults set only the Safety floor.

Where this comes from. Alpha School runs a weekly student-led Town Hall where kids vote on rules, elect officials, and set standards. Its co-founder published how it works in April 2026. Alpha's examples come from fourth and fifth graders. This version is for 14 to 18 year olds living together. [Source](#)

Why it works, per Alpha. Rules handed down from above last only as long as an adult is in the room. When adults own the rules, breaking them becomes the fast path to status. When students write the standards, the students holding them become the ones others want to be like. That lines up with Yeager's status research in section 2.

What Alpha saw happen

- Kids voted a low weekly work minimum, saw within days it was too low, and raised it twice to a bar above what adults had planned.
- Students worried about a risky recess game called their own meeting to set tougher penalties.
- Kids banned a habit that annoyed everyone, then lifted the ban weeks later, and the habit stayed under control.

How House Town Hall runs

1. **When.** Once a week, same night, 30 minutes. Sunday evening works well: it resets the week.
2. **Who runs it.** Students. Three roles, elected every quarter:
 - Chair: runs the agenda and calls on speakers.
 - Vote keeper: runs votes and counts them.
 - Scribe: keeps the running log of what passed.
3. **Adult's role.** Alpha aims for 95% student voice. The RA speaks only to name a Safety floor issue or ask a question.
4. **Opening.** Someone reads the house standards aloud. Students draft these on Day 2 and vote them in during week 2. Every resident signs off.
5. **Proposals.** Anyone drops a proposal in the house box during the week, signed or anonymous: a new norm, a change, a complaint.
6. **Debate and vote.** Hear both sides. Vote privately, heads down or on slips. Majority passes.
7. **The log.** Everything passed goes in the house log, which becomes the rulebook. Families get the log after every Town Hall.
8. **Emergency sessions.** Any three students can call a short meeting if something can't wait a week.

The Safety floor. Town Hall can't vote on these. The RA explains the reason for each at the first meeting. La Lumiere's dorm uses the same line: students shape the rules, core safety rules stay fixed. [Source](#)

Safety floor rule	The reason we give
Sign out and in when leaving the house	We need to know where you are if something happens
No alcohol, drugs, vapes, or weapons	Law, and your family trusted us with you
Guests follow house guest rules; no overnight guests	Everyone who lives here gets a say in who's in their home
Medications go through the RA	Mixed-up meds are a real medical risk
Anyone can report a safety concern with no penalty	We want to hear about problems early
Violence, threats, or harassment go straight to the RA	Nobody should feel unsafe where they sleep

What Town Hall decides. Chores, quiet hours, common-room rules, phone norms at meals and after lights-out, weekend plans, how to spend the activity budget, and consequences for breaking house norms that aren't Safety floor rules.

What the RA does if a vote goes badly. Nothing, unless it touches the Safety floor. Let it run, like Alpha's adults did with the low work minimum. Bring the evidence to the next meeting as a question.

5. Daily and weekly rhythm

A steady weekly rhythm means students always know what's next and nobody drifts into a screen by default. Lights-out is about 10pm on school nights, per the job description.

School night (Sunday to Thursday)

Time	What happens
5:00 to 5:15pm	Arrive home and eat a healthy snack: fruit, yogurt, eggs, nuts. RA checks in with anyone who seems off.

Time	What happens
5:15 to 6:15pm	Practice block, which should feel like play. Each student picks something they enjoy getting better at, unrelated to their business. No grades and no pressure: the log is for streaks and bragging rights. The term ends in a showcase for families.
6:30 to 7:30pm	Family dinner, phones in a basket. Students rotate cooking crews on set nights.
7:30 to 9:00pm	Evening block: tonight's activity (section 10) or open work time
9:00 to 9:30pm	Chores and free time in common spaces
9:30 to 10:00pm	Wind down in rooms. Phone norm for this window set at Town Hall.
10:00pm	Lights-out

Business crunch time. A student can skip an evening block to work on their business once or twice a week if they tell the RA why. If it becomes a pattern, the RA and student sit down and plan how to get the work done in the time set aside for it.

Friday and Saturday. Later curfew and lights-out, set at Town Hall within a Safety floor maximum. Brook Hill allows lights to stay on Friday and Saturday as long as no one is disturbed. [Source](#)

Weekly anchors

- Sunday: House Town Hall, then prep for the week.
- One weeknight: big house dinner, students cook.
- Saturday: the week's main outing.
- RA's night off: backup RA runs the house from this handbook.

Chores. Common spaces only: kitchen, trash, laundry area, lounge. They rotate weekly. Students decide the rotation and trades at Town Hall. Doing someone else's chore needs a trade logged by the scribe.

Rooms. A standard students agree on at Town Hall: bed made, floor clear, no open food. La Lumiere uses a 0 to 5 scale where 3 passes and 5 is exemplary, which gives students a bar above passing to aim for. [Source](#) This must be observable i.e. covers pulled tautly over the bed with no wrinkles. See picture:

Image — A room that passes: bed made with the cover pulled tight, floor clear, desk in ...

Guests. Day students and approved visitors are welcome during set hours. Town Hall sets the hours and the rules inside the Safety floor.

Earned freedom. Privileges grow with shown responsibility, measured only by house standards anyone can observe: signing out and back in on time, rooms passing, chores done, curfew kept, and behavior. Grades play no part. A student who meets the standards for a month earns wider limits on weekends and independent outings. Families hear when a student earns a new privilege.

6. Standards and consequences

Consequences fix the problem and hold the standard. Each one ends when the problem is fixed.

Three tiers

Tier	Examples	Who handles it	What happens
House norm	Missed chore, noise after quiet hours, messy common room	Students, by the consequences Town Hall set	The fix plus whatever Town Hall voted
Pattern	Same house norm broken three times, curfew missed, room fails repeatedly	RA, one-on-one	Private talk, a plan, freedom narrowed until it's fixed
Safety floor	Leaving without signing out, substances, violence, threats	RA, then school leadership and family	Escalation ladder (section 8)

Families hear about every tier. House-norm consequences go in the regular update. A pattern gets a call to the family the same week, after the student has heard it first. A Safety floor break follows the escalation ladder in section 8.

Brook Hill pulls off-campus privileges when a room fails inspection and restores them as soon as it passes. The student controls how long it lasts. [Source](#)

Two limits apply to every pulled privilege. Walks, exercise, and time outdoors are never taken away, because they help a student reset. And when a room that usually passes suddenly fails, the first response is a private check-in (section 7): a sudden change in how someone keeps their space can mean something else is wrong.

How the RA gives correction

1. Private, never in front of the group.
2. Say the standard and why it matters.
3. Say you believe they can meet it.
4. Ask what got in the way, then listen.
5. Agree on the fix and when you'll check back.

Steps 2 and 3 come from a 2014 study by Yeager and colleagues. Seventh graders got essay comments with a note attached: "I'm giving you these comments because I have very high expectations and I know that you can reach them." Among Black students, 64% chose to revise their essays, against 27% of those who got a neutral note. [Source](#)

Repair. When a student's action hurts someone in the house, the fix includes making it right with that person. The RA helps set it up. The apology follows the five parts Gary Chapman and Jennifer Thomas describe in *The Five Languages of Apology*. [Source](#)

1. **Express regret:** "I'm sorry."
2. **Accept responsibility:** "I was wrong," with no excuse attached.
3. **Make restitution:** "What can I do to make it right?" Replace what broke, or take over a chore.
4. **Repent:** say what will change next time, then do it.
5. **Request forgiveness:** ask, and accept that the other person may need time.

What never happens here

- Public call-outs or penalty uniforms. La Lumiere's Friday holds in school dress and blazer are the kind of visible penalty Yeager's work predicts reads as humiliation.
- Group punishment for one person's choice.
- Consequences with no end date.
- Losing meals, sleep, or family calls as a penalty.

Tracking small stuff. The RA keeps a private log of broken norms. The purpose is early warning. La Lumiere says the same about its points: many small slips often signal a student who needs help. [Source](#)

7. Knowing every student

The RA should notice a student drifting as soon as the pattern picks up. The job description names four things to watch: mood, health, conflict, and loneliness.

Weekly one-on-one. Ten minutes with every student, every week, somewhere low-pressure, like a walk to the bodega or a chat on a bench, always where others can see.

Three questions, asked the same way each week so changes stand out:

1. What was the best and worst part of your week?
2. How are you feeling? Physically, Mentally, Emotionally
3. Anything you want me to know or do?

Private notes after each one. One line per student per week, plus a status. Over a month the pattern shows.

Status	Means	RA action
Steady	Normal for this student	Keep going
Watch	One change: sleeping badly, quieter, a fight with a roommate	Extra check-in within 48 hours
Act	Several changes, or any single serious sign below	Same day: talk to the student, then escalate (section 8)

Signs to act on the same day

- Skipping meals or group time for several days
- Big changes in sleep, eating, or hygiene
- Pulling away from friends, or friends saying they're worried
- Talk of hopelessness, being a burden, or not wanting to be here
- Signs of substance use
- Injuries they won't explain

Make it easy to tell someone. The Safety floor protects anyone who reports a concern about a friend. Say this at the first Town Hall and repeat it every month. Teenagers often tell a peer before an adult.

Anonymous feedback form. A standing form any student can fill in at any time, with no name attached, about the house, the RA, or another student. The RA reads it daily. Safety concerns go straight to the ladder in section 8. Everything else is summarized, without identifying anyone, at the next Town Hall and in the family update.

Where the RA's role ends. The RA notices, listens, and connects students to help. Counseling and medical care belong to professionals. If a student says they might hurt themselves, stay with them and escalate right away. In the US, 988 is the Suicide and Crisis Lifeline by call or text, and 911 is for immediate danger. Families and the escalation ladder (section 8) are engaged at the same time.

Safeguarding. An adult living with minors follows these without exception.

- **Boundaries.** One-on-ones happen where others can see. The RA never goes into a student's room with the door closed, and no student is alone with the RA in the RA's apartment.
- **Messages.** The RA texts students in group threads or in conversations school leadership can see. No private social media messages with students, and no following their personal accounts.
- **Reporting abuse.** New York names school staff as mandated reporters. Whether or not the law covers the RA's title, the RA acts as one: any reasonable suspicion of abuse or neglect is reported immediately to the Statewide Central Register (mandated reporter line 1-800-635-1522), then to school leadership. [Source](#)
- **Health.** Every student's allergies and medications are on file before move-in. Medications given are logged. For students with a prescription, epinephrine goes on every outing. CPR and first-aid certification stay current.
- **Fire safety.** A fire drill in the first week and once a term, with exits and the outdoor meeting point posted in the house.

8. Escalation ladder and family communication

The job description calls this the coverage ladder: who the RA calls, in what order, and when families hear. Founders still needs to name who fills each role. The open questions at the end of this handbook track that.

The ladder

Level	Situation	First call	Then	Family told
Routine	Minor illness, homesickness, roommate friction	Handled in house	Log it	In the next update
Concern	A student on Act status (section 7)	Student's advisor	Counselor if needed	Within 24 hours
Serious	Illness needing a doctor, a fight, a Safety floor break	Backup RA to hold the house	Head of school next morning	Same day
Urgent	Self-harm talk, substance use, violence, student missing past curfew with no contact	Head of school	Counselor or on-call clinician	Within 1 hour
Emergency	Medical emergency, danger to life, missing student at risk	911	Head of school, then family	Right after 911

Missing student

1. Call and text the student. Check their sign-out and ask their friends. Check with anyone who has their location, if leadership approves location sharing.
2. Past 30 minutes with no contact after curfew: call the head of school and the family.
3. Past one hour, or any sign of danger: call 911.

Talking to families

- **Anytime.** When the RA notices something worth praising, the family hears it that day. [La Lumiere](#) invites parents to share good news as well as concerns; this goes the other way too.
- **Photos.** Selfies and activity pictures from outings and house nights go to the parent group, only for students whose families and who themselves agreed to photos.
- **Check-ins.** A short note after each outing, and after any one-on-one where a student moved to Watch.
- **Weekly.** A summary: what happened, what's coming, and the Town Hall log.
- **Monthly.** A personal note to each family with one specific, true observation about their kid.

- **Right away.** Anything on the ladder at Serious or above. Calm, direct, facts first, then what you're doing about it.

A template for hard calls. "This is [name], [student]'s RA. [Student] is safe right now. Here's what happened: [facts]. Here's what we've done: [actions]. Here's what happens next: [plan]. I'll call you again by [time]." If the student isn't safe yet, lead with what's being done.

9. Out in the city

Every group outing follows the same routine, so a student separated on the subway knows where to wait and the RA knows where to look.

Before leaving

- ☐ Headcount and names on a list, shared with the backup RA
- ☐ Buddy pairs set; buddies stay together all trip
- ☐ Every phone charged, the RA's number saved, location sharing on for the trip if Town Hall agreed to it
- ☐ Meeting point named out loud at the destination
- ☐ Return time sent to the parent group for bigger trips

On the subway

- The RA boards last and gets off first so nobody is left on the platform.
- If a student gets left on a platform: stay there. If a student is on the train without the group: get off at the next stop and wait on the platform. The RA comes back for them.
- Headcount after every transfer.

At the destination

- Headcount on arrival and before leaving.
- Free time in buddy pairs, with a set check-in time and place.
- Older students with a track record can earn small-group free time without the RA nearby. This is earned freedom from section 5.

Independent outings. Students who go out on their own sign out with where, who, and when back. Town Hall sets the limits for how far and how late, within a Safety floor maximum. Brook Hill defines an extended campus with named streets students can walk in groups with a phone. A named zone around the residence works the same way here.

[Source](#)

Rideshare. Brook Hill allows Uber and Lyft only for students 18 or older, or with a student who is, and only with parent permission. La Lumiere requires groups of two or more. Founders should pick a rule and tell families. [Brook Hill](#) · [La Lumiere](#)

RA kit. First-aid kit, water, charged battery pack, printed list of students with emergency contacts and medical notes, phone, wallet, keys.

10. Programming

Every evening and weekend has something better to do than a laptop. The job description asks for a packed calendar on purpose, and says presence without programming is failure in year one.

The weekly template

Slot	Type	Examples
Sunday evening	Town Hall + week prep	Town Hall, then a low-key movie or games
Monday evening	Move: team	Pickup soccer, basketball, volleyball
Tuesday evening	Cook	Cooking crew makes house dinner
Wednesday evening	Rest, or pitch roast	A quiet night in. Students work on their businesses all day, so any work tonight is a pitch roast: pitch an idea, take the roast, laugh.
Thursday evening	Move: solo skill	Climbing gym, run club, yoga, boxing class
Friday evening	Out	A free event, show, or neighborhood night
Saturday	Move: outdoors, then the big outing	A morning hike, bike ride, or kayak on the Hudson; then a museum, park, borough, or day trip

Rules for good programming

- 1. Offer choices.** At least two options on big nights, so nobody sits one out because they hate the only option.

2. **Hand it over.** By month three, students run at least half the calendar. An elected activities lead proposes plans at Town Hall.
3. **Mix boarding and day students** on Friday and Saturday where it helps. The job description asks for this.
4. **Mostly free or cheap.** New York has free events every week. Town Hall votes on how to spend the activity budget.
5. **Measure it.** After each event, note who came and one line on how it went. Drop what doesn't work.
6. **One statement piece a month.** A big shared challenge students will remember, rotating between moving, performing, hosting, serving and teaching: reading a poem at a Nuyorican open mic, hosting a community night, volunteering at the marathon, walking the length of Manhattan. The sample week lists a year of them with dates and age rules.

A sample week. See the companion doc, Founders School House Week, for one real week of meals and free New York events.

11. Student leadership and backup coverage

Students hold elected and appointed roles, and a trained backup RA can run any night.

Student roles

Role	What they do	How they get it	Term
Town Hall chair, vote keeper, scribe	Run the weekly meeting (section 4)	Elected at Town Hall	1 quarter
Activities lead	Proposes and plans the weekend calendar with the RA	Applies, elected at Town Hall	1 semester
Kitchen lead	Runs cooking crews and the shopping list	Applies, chosen by the RA	1 semester
House mentor	Upperclass student who helps new students settle in	Applies, chosen by the RA	1 year

Earning a role is what gives it status. La Lumiere's prefects are older students who apply, get selected, live in the dorm, and help plan events. [Source](#)

Backup coverage. The job description asks the RA to build more coverage as boarding grows so home life never depends on one person.

- ☐ Name a backup RA who covers the RA's weekly night off and sick days.
- ☐ Train the backup with the EDGE method from Scouts BSA leadership training: the lead RA **explains** each routine and why it exists, **demonstrates** it on a real night, **guides** the trainee through running it, then **enables** the trainee to run it alone while the lead watches. Training covers at least a full week of evenings and one weekend. [Source](#)
- ☐ Before running the house alone, the trainee builds one real project that improves it: a sign-in and sign-out app, an activity website, or a family-communications tracker that shows parents what went out and when.
- ☐ Students interview the candidate, and Town Hall approves them before they run a night.
- ☐ Backup has this handbook, the student list with medical notes, and the escalation contacts.
- ☐ Every Friday, the RA sends the backup a one-paragraph handoff: who is on Watch, what's planned, anything unusual.
- ☐ Add a second RA when boarding passes about 15 to 20 students. Brook Hill assigns one house parent per 20 students. [Source](#)

12. Milestones

The right column says how to tell each target is met.

When	Target	How we'll know
3 months	Every student's interests mapped	Each student has a one-page map of interests from their one-on-ones, and the calendar includes something from every map
3 months	First quarterly Town Hall election held	New chair, vote keeper and scribe elected and handed the log
3 months	Early warning works	Every Watch flag gets a check-in within 48 hours
6 months	A real evening and weekend rhythm	Calendar published every week; 80% of students at three or more events a week

When	Target	How we'll know
6 months	Norms stick without constant policing	Students propose and enforce norms in the Town Hall log; RA-level corrections fall for three months running
6 months	Families trust the RA as the face of home life	Every family hears from the house at least twice a week; 4 out of 5 or higher on a quarterly family survey; no family surprised by news
6 months	Students rate the house	4 out of 5 or higher on the quarterly anonymous student survey
6 months	Backup coverage exists	A backup RA trained with EDGE, approved by students, has run at least four nights alone
12 months	Student life runs like a product	Weekly programming repeats without the RA building it from scratch
12 months	Boarding and day students mix where it helps	Day students at half or more of weekend events
12 months	Playbooks others can run	A new RA runs a full week from this handbook

The 6- and 12-month targets come from the job description. The 3-month targets are added here.

Sources

- [Founders School, Head of Student Life \(Live-in RA\) job description](#)
- [Alpha School, "What Happens When You Let Kids Choose Their Own Rules, Rewards, and Punishments"](#)
- [La Lumiere School, Residential Life Student Handbook 2023-24](#)
- [Brook Hill School, Residential Life Student Handbook 2025-26](#)
- [Simon & Schuster, 10 to 25 by David Yeager](#)
- [Youth Prevention Mentors, "The Mentor Mindset"](#)
- [Gary Chapman and Jennifer Thomas, The Five Languages of Apology](#)
- [ScoutSmarts, "The BSA's Teaching EDGE Method"](#)

- [Stanford SPARQ, "Wise critiques help students succeed"](#)
- [Andreessen Horowitz culture document \(a16z, About\)](#): source of the principles "We celebrate the good times," "We are all different, we recognize that, and we win," "We do it for the group" (a16z: "We do it for the team"), and the first-class commitments on being early, not publicly criticizing others, and keeping your word
- "We round up" (Alex Hormozi)
- Camp Kesem: source of "walk beside us" in "We stick together." [Tablet Magazine](#) traces the saying to Jewish summer camp tradition; it is often misattributed to Albert Camus
- [New York State Education Department, "Mandated Reporters of Child Abuse and Neglect"](#)
- CLAP: Connection, Learning, Altruism, Play (Alex Banayan)

13. Open questions for Founders School

- ☐ Who is on call after hours from school leadership?
- ☐ Is there a school counselor or an outside clinician on call?
- ☐ Which urgent care and hospital are nearest the residence?
- ☐ Who is the backup RA, and how fast can they reach the house?
- ☐ Is there a chef or food preparation plan you had in mind?
- ☐ How many students will board in year one?
- ☐ Which Safety floor rules do the Founding Families want added or changed before move-in?
- ☐ What is the photo consent policy for pictures sent to families?
- ☐ What is the rideshare rule for students under 18?
- ☐ Which tool will run the anonymous feedback form?